

To whom it may concern,

I am incredibly proud to write this reference in support of Callan's nomination for the Scottish Theatre Awards. I have worked alongside Callan for around three years now, and in that time he has become not only someone I trust completely within a theatre setting, but also a genuine friend. I have never known him to approach theatre with anything less than complete commitment, care and precision. He is one of those people who does not need to be asked twice, and more often than not, he has already noticed what needs done before anyone else has.

During our six-week summer programme with Summer in the City, Callan volunteered as my Stage Manager and became one of the most important people in making the entire programme work. He handled lighting, sound, venue safety and technical preparation across the productions, often using his own equipment and giving up his own time despite none of this being required of him. What stood out most to me was his determination. He never treated the role like "just volunteering." He treated every performance as something worth getting right, and gave the young performers the same level of care and professionalism you would expect in any professional theatre environment.

For me, Callan was not simply someone volunteering during the programme. He was my Stage Manager, my technical support, someone I could completely rely on, and also my friend throughout six very demanding weeks. In an environment where things could change quickly and problems could appear minutes before a performance, having Callan beside me made a genuine difference. I knew that if something went wrong, he would stay calm, work it out and get the job done. That trust is something I do not take lightly, and after working with him for three years, he has earned it completely.

Callan represents so much of what I think theatre should be about: generosity, teamwork, passion and people willing to work just as hard behind the scenes as those standing in the spotlight. Much of what he did over those six weeks may never have been seen by an audience, but every show was stronger because he was there. I could not be more proud of the young person and theatre-maker he has become, and I genuinely cannot think of anyone more deserving of recognition for the dedication he continues to give to theatre.

Kindest regards,  
Liam Campbell.